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ACHAEMENIDS-TYPE PAINTED POTTERY IN CENTRAL AND EASTERN ANATOLIA - ONE WAY OF DEVELOPMENT TRANSCAUCASUS

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At first the existence of contacts with the Persian world became obvious due to data found in the Colchian Collective burials of 9th 6th cc BC. It was attested by finds of the so-called 3rd type whole-cast daggers. Among them were three samples discovered at Ergeta (necropolis 1, No. 5, 7 pit-grave; No. 3, 2); and two samples at Dghvaba necropolis (7th c BC). They belong to the so-called "Near Eastern-tye" daggers, which find their closest analogies with the Hasanlu IV daggers

The bronze dagger - found in South Georgia, namely in a cenotaph excavated in the Mzetamze necropolis - also has connection with the Western Persian world. Its closest analogies are daggers attributed to the group 31-35 by P Calmeyer. They are united into the artefacts belonging to the Neo-Babylonian period². It could be said with confidence that this dagger was made in Luristan. (Figures 1 b-c). Discovery of calf-rings was also evidenced at the Mzetamze necropolis (Figure 1a). This fact has direct and synchronous parallel at Luristan, namely at the Gul Khanan necropolis (burial 37)³. It is quite possible that the fact of spreading of the so-called jugs with a tubular handle all over Colchis points to the existence of the early contact; they are found at nearly all sites dating from the 7th 4th centuries BC (Batumi castle, Pichvnari, Kokhi, Simagre, Ochamchire, Ergeta, Mtisdziri, Dablagomi, Kutaisi, Kulevi, Brili, etc), Pottery of this type originally appeared in Western Iran. In recent years it is evidenced at Qalaichi (Cf.: Fine Ware, 800-600 B.C); Grakliani Hill excavations support this early relationship with Iran - VII c BC - "pixida" similar to the Susa find was found here.

It is supposed that the Achaemenids appeared in Transcaucasus during the reign of Darius I. It is sufficing to recall the theme of fighting on the Vani diadem, Achaemenid bracelets or a decoration of a silver girdle found in grave 24; or gold pendants from Sairkhe with representations of Ahuramazda"⁴, usage of both Aramaic and Greek inscriptions, cheek-pieces of the Achaemenid type from Sairkhe, applications for adornment of a shroud, corresponding to the Achaemenid royal standard from Vani, double bull column capital, etc. This nominal subordination could be applied only to the eastern part of Colchis. From the point of spreading of Achaemenid artefacts, especially remarkable is an Achaemenid bronze bridle recently found in Chibati village, which reveals more

or less resemblance with those excavated at Itkhvisi and Vani, though the former was accomplished on a much higher artistic level. Its processing is of the same kind as in the case of the Persian bridle found in the "Persian debris" in Athens, as well as at Persepolis and Deve-Huyuk.⁵ The cheek-piece from Chibati is wonderfully processed and ends with a dynamic sculptural representation of a jumping sphinx with crouched upper legs and stretched hind legs (Figure 2 a). The horse-bit found at Chibati differs from all others of this kind, including the so-called Persian-type bridles (Figure 3, after V. Erlikh). excavated on the territory of the Central Caucasus, by its especially high artistic level. Supposedly, the bridle in question is dated from the 5th 4th cc BC. It follows a long-term Western-Iranian tradition of adorning cheek-pieces with animal representations (horse-bits with various representations are well known in the Luristan and Achaemenid worlds -cheek-pieces with representations of sphinxes, gryphons, ibexes or bulls with human heads).

In addition, double-protoma capital and a rhyton made of clay, which is painted in Achaemenid an imitation of a style, could be regarded as evidence of retaining of the Achaemenid traditions.

It is very well known that part of the archaeological material discovered on the territory of Caucasian Iberia, which is dated from the 6th-4th centuries BC, has traces of influence of the Achaemenid world"⁶.

The residence of Gumbati in Caucasian Iberia is repeatedly published in the context of the Achaemenid impact in Iberia⁷. The sites synchronous to it (5th-4th centuries BC) were evidenced only in recent years in Grakliani Gora and

1.Mikeladze, 1990: 57, pl. XXIV 9-10; Haerink, Overlat, 2004: 31-70

2 Moorey, 1971: 113-129

3 Haerink, 1991:35

4 Nadiradz, 1990: 98-122

5Ivantchik, 2001: 180-188

6 Licheli, 2001: 62; Makharadze, 1999: 57-59

7 Knauss, 2001: 125-145

Darakoi. They have presented us with an opportunity for making clear some aspects of the Iberian-Achaemenid interrelations. From this point of view, results of the excavations carried out in 2008-2012 at Grakliani Gora (in the central part of Transcaucasus) are especially remarkable⁸.

This multilayered site especially intensively reveals the settlement of the territory in the 5th-4th centuries BC, i.e. in that very period when the policy of the Achaemenid Empire in Transcaucasia was fully realized and all opportunities for assimilation of cultural relations were used by the local population.

A part of the burials and constructions revealed at Grakliani Gora is attributed to the Achaemenid period: for instance, an architectural complex, dated from the 450-350 BC⁹. Two stages should be distinguished in the construction of this building: the first (earlier, dating from the 5th century BC), which is represented in the eastern part of the building. Two parallel rows of the foundation built with cobblestone are preserved here. Remains of the analogous masonry scattered across the same terrace should be related to the same stage. It is obvious that utilization of a cobblestone foundation implies the existence of a peculiar wall structure, which has not remained. However, if we take into consideration the foundations of the Achaemenid residence at Qarajamirli, in Azerbaijan¹⁰ it is possible to suppose that the wall at Grakliani Gora was built of mud brick. The excavations in 2012 again revealed the constructions dated from the 5th-4th centuries BC, where one of the sanctuaries came to light repeatedly, though partially:

1. a peculiar altar with three phiale-like little indentations on its façade, which has no analogies in the Caucasus;
2. a podium-type fire altar.

Constructions of similar planning have not been evidenced in the Caucasus. This is square in the plan clay construction with hemispherical fire-bowl, covered by fine plaster. It has similarities in the territory of Western Iran, namely at Nush-I Jan. There the Fire Temple was excavated, consisting of several rooms. One of them is a large triangular cella (Room NI) with a free-standing fire altar. The altar is 85 m high with four projecting steps at the top and a small hemispherical fire bowl in the centre. The top is square, measuring 1.4 m across. Rather surprisingly the altar is built entirely of mud-bricks, the whole being covered by several layers of fine white plaster. The altar is placed off centre, like on Grakliani Hill. It is supposed that¹¹ it is perfectly possible that the Nush-I Jan altar illustrates the early Iranian type of altar that was transformed during the reign of Cyrus (590-530BC). On Grakliani Hill we have a simplified version of the same type of fire altar.

"Achaemenid type" pottery

First of all I'd like to underline that, for an estimation of the level of production of Achaemenid type pottery in Georgia, I'm following the definitions of the Achaemenid painted pottery done by Robert H. Dyson for Hasanlu, Period II/IIIA. The distinction is useful and Western Triangle Ware is used by him for all stylistically-related materials in western Iran, eastern Turkey and Georgia. For the original 'Triangle Ware', we shall reserve the name 'Classic Triangle Ware'. Pottery of 'the

Achaemenid type' was identified among the clay vessels found in cultural layers and burials dated from the 5th-4th centuries BC at Grakliani Gora (Figures 4, 5). Under the terms of the Achaemenid type local imitations of the Achaemenid production are meant:

1. jugs and dishes, imitating the Achaemenid painted pottery;
2. imitations of the Achaemenid profiled phialae;
3. stemmed bowls;
4. clay imitations of Achaemenid silver bowls.

Imported original Achaemenid pottery comprises a separate group of earthenware, which is distinguishable both by its fabric and accomplishment of its décor. Microscopic analyses show that under the microscope the imported sample represents a fine-grained clay, without any mechanical inclusions and is characterised with small-grain composition, consisting of very small mechanical material and very few inclusions. There are rusty sections identified with different sizes and shapes. Material is so fine-grained that microscopic clearing of case minerals is impossible.

According to X-ray analyses, pottery is represented with quartz, plagioclase, hydro-mica and amorphous iron admixtures.

For painting the surface of the vessel, according to the data of the optic photometry, iron rusts, hydro-rusts and calcium carbonate are used. In two samples #897 and #1047 there was also lead rust (probably lead carbonate). According to this result we cannot connect these changes to the composition of the paint.

8 Licheli, 2011: 135-156

9 Lacheli, 2011: 140

10 Babaev-Gagoshidze-Knauss, 2007: 31-47

11 Roaf-Stronach, 1973

In comparison, in the locally-made pottery (#249), different to the previous samples, there are inclusions of different circled rocks basalt, fine-grained, quartzite rock, (sandstone or flinty rock) and so on. There are also inclusions of ore-minerals and carbonates. The piece of a rock could well be a piece of old pottery.

The Achaemenid-Type Painted Pottery discovered in Iberia is, according to its ornamentation, divided into four groups¹². The earliest is the pottery of the first style, which existed in the 5th-4th centuries BC and is related to the Achaemenid impact. However, it is certain that any kind of similar pottery found in Iran itself or in Iberia, Azerbaijan, Armenia or Eastern Anatolia could possess some peculiar features in each case¹³. Painted pottery found at Grakliani Gora mainly was represented by jugs, among which three groups could be distinguished according to their shapes:

1. jugs, which have maximum diameter in the upper part. They are mainly produced in the 5th-4th centuries B.C
2. jugs with spherical bodies; handles are attached on their shoulders and rim (or just under the rim); jugs with such shapes are characteristic of the 6th-first half of the 4th century B.C;
3. the so-called jugs with 'pear-shaped bodies', maximum diameters of which are in the lower parts of the body. Such shapes are usually characteristic of the 4th-3rd centuries BC.

This seems to be a general chronological framework with the existence of certain deviations. For instance, the jugs of the 2nd type are evidenced in the 1st century BC.

Seventy-six painted and colored vessels of the 'Achaemenid type' were found in the 265 burials excavated up to now (which is 29% of all graves). Their fragments are found in a comparatively greater amount in cultural layers of the settlement under discussion. Several of them will be described as models:

- a) a red-painted jug with light-colored fabric, on the shoulder of which triangles are painted with tips directed upwards, lying with their bases on a line circling the mid-belly. Two similar circular and concentric bands are drawn in the lower part of the body;
- b) a pear-shaped jar. Its neck is encircled with four concentric lines. Triangles join these lines with their tips, while their bases stand on concentric circles. Handle is decorated with vertical lines (Cf.: Hasanlu IIIA; Cimin Tepe Altin Tepe);
- c) painted and coloured cups (Cf: Deposits 1-8 of Satrapal Sardis cups.)¹⁴;
- d) Kohl-tube from Grakliani Gora, found together with a tripod phiale, belongs to the group I of D. Barag's chronology and is dated to the 5th century BC.
- e) Bronze, silver and golden discs of Susa type¹⁵ (Figure 2d), as well as bronze bracelets with representation of double-protoma figurines of horses and "calendar" (Figure 2 b - c).

Of pottery finds, besides fragments of painted jugs, a grey-fabric phiale with an omphalos and four almond-shaped bulges at its base is noteworthy. It represents a clay imitation of those numerous Achaemenid silver bowls which are discovered in Georgia, at the littoral of the Black Sea and Asia Minor¹⁶. Only one Achaemenid Siglos had been found between Grakliani Gora and Atskuri archaeological sites.

Burney and Lang¹⁷, as well as Summers and Anna Parker's (for Northeastern Anatolia: on the periphery of empires) investigation shows that in Eastern Turkey, these types of painted pottery from Van (Triangle Ware and Festoon Ware) do not begin before the Achaemenid period.

As is known, for Western Anatolia the chronology of Achaemenid pottery (cups) found in Sardis and published by Elspeth R. M. Dusenberre shows the development and use of the vessels at Sardis over the course of approximately three centuries, from the early fifth to the late third century BC.

Conclusions

Taking into consideration this documental background, we have to assume that in the different regions producing "Achaemenid type" pottery in the chronological framework of early 5th early 3d cc BC, there were three main regions: Caucasus, Eastern Anatolia and Asia Minor.

12 Narimanishvili-Shatberashvili, 2002: 54-70

13 Dyson, 1999: 101-110; Stronach, 1974: 239-248; Hansen-Postgate, 1968: 105-135; Meade, 1968: 105-134

14 Dusenberre, 2000: 73-102

15 Licheli, 2011: 140

16 Licheli, 2007: 55-67

17 Burney-Lang, 1971: 158-9

R. Ghirshman Western Iran	T. Cuyler Young Western Iran	Robert H. Dyson Western Iran	Elisapeth R. M. Dusinberre Sardis	V. Licheli, G. Narimanishvili.. Central Transcaucasus
8 th -6 th c BC 6 th c-5 th cc BC 5 th -4 th cc BC	1250-1000 BC 1000-800 BC 700 - 400BC	400-275 cc BC	Early 5 th c BC E Early 5 th c BC M M-1 4 th c BC M 4 th c BC M 3 rd c? BC Late Late 3 rd c? BC Late	6 th c BC (?) 1 st half of 5 th c BC (?) 5 th – 1 st half of 4 th BC 4 TH – 3 rd cc BC 3 rd – 2 nd cc BC

Biographical note

Vakhtang Licheli works on the thematics of 2nd - 1st millennium BC. He processes archaeological excavations in different and multilayered archaeological sites of central and west Transcaucasus. He is the head of several international projects, as well as being the author of three monographs and up to 100 articles (published in France, England, Italy, Spain, Poland, Netherlands etc.).

Özet/Abstract

Merkezi Transkafkasya ve Doğu Anadolu'daki Akhamenid Tipi Boyah Seramikler - Tek Yönlü Bir Gelişme

Pers Dünyası'yla bağlantıların varlığı, ilk önce MO 9-6 yüzyıllara ait Kolkhis Toplu Gömülerindeki verilerin ortaya çıkmasıyla hariz hale geldi. Bu durum 3. Tip olarak isimlendirilen tümüyle dükdım hançerlerle doğrulanmıştır. Gney Gürcistan'da bulunan bir bronz hançer ki bu hançer Mzetanze nekropolünde kazılan bir anıt mezarda hulunmuştur. Batı Pers Dünyası ile yakın ilişki ve benzerelıklere sahiptir. Bu hançerin en yakın paralelleri P. Calmeyer tarafından 31-35 olarak tanımlanan gruptaki hançerlerdir.

Tahmin edilen ocho ki, Transkafkasya'da ortaya çıkan Akhamenid varlığı Darius I dönemine aittir. Gayet iyi bilinmektedir ki; Kafkasya İberyasında (Kolkhis-Batı Gürciastan) keşfedilen ve 6-4. yüzyıllara tarihlendirilen arkeolojik malzemelerin bir kısmı Akhamenid Dünyası'nın etkilerinin izlerini taşımaktadır. Çok evreli Grakliani Gora verleşimi, Transkafkasya'daki Akhamenid İmparatorluğu'nun politikasın tümüyle realize olduğu ve kültürel ilişkilerin asimile olması için tiem olanakların yerel halk tarafından kullanıldığı bir dönem olan MO 5 ve 4. yüzyıla tarihlendirilen çok sayıda malzeme sunmuştur.

Grakliani Gora'da ortaya çıkarılan mezarlar ve yapıların bir kısmı Akhamenid Dönemine tarihlendirilmiştir. Örneğin, kompleks bir mimari yapı MO 450-350 yılına tarihlendirilmiştir. Öncelikle, Gürcistan'da üretilen Akamenid tipi seramiklerin üretim seviyesini tahmini değerini belirtmek isterim. "Akamenid tipi seramikler, Garkliani Gora'da MO 5 ve 4. yüzyıllara tarihlendirilen kültür tabakalarında ve mezardan ele geçen kil kaplar arasında tespit edildi. Akamenid tipi terimi altında yerel Akamenid taklitler kastedilmektedir: 1. Testiler ve pişirme kapları, boyalı Akamenid seramik taklitleri. 2. Piale formu Akamenid tokditler. 3. Kulplu kaseler. 4. Gümüş Akamenid kaselerinin, kil taklitleri. thal edilen orjinal Akamenid pişmiş toprak kaplar ayrı bir grup oluşturur, öyle ki onların hem yapısı hem de bezemesi ayut edilebilir. Ilheria'da keşfedilen boyalı seramiklerin bezemelerine göre, Akamenid tipi

seramikler 4 gruba ayrılmıştır. Bu güne kadar kazılan 265 mezar içerisinde, 76 boyalı ve renkli Akamenid tipi kap ele geçmiştir.

Bu belgelerin geçmişlerini göz önünde bulundurursak, MÖ erken 5. 3. yüzyıl kronoloji çerçevesi içerisinde, Akhamenid tipi seramik üretimi yapan farklı bölgelerin varlığı kabullenmeliyiz. Bu bölgeler, Kafkaslar. Doğu Anadolu ve Küçük Asya (Anadolu) bölgeleridir

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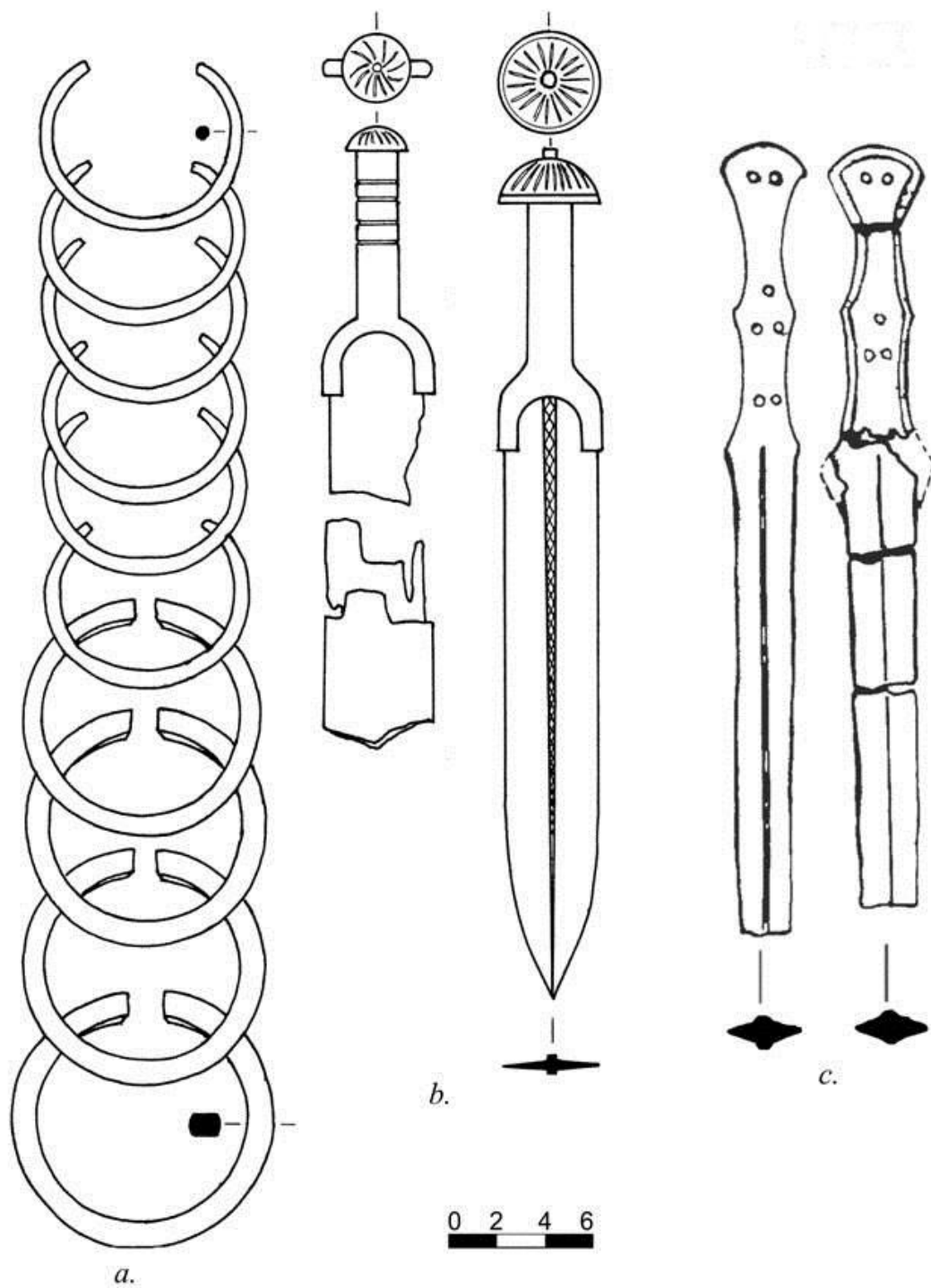
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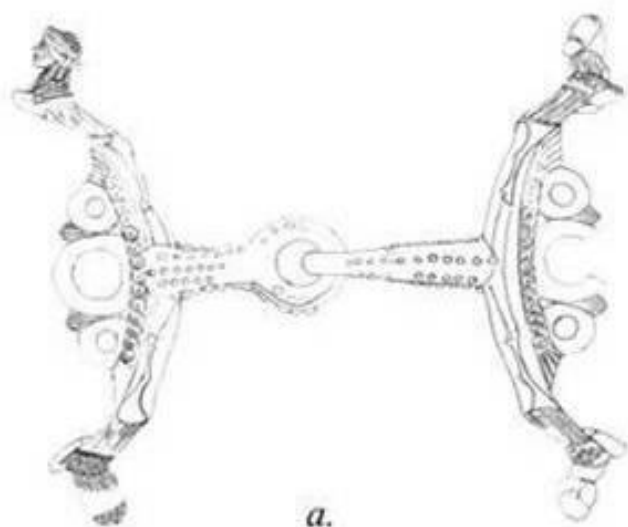
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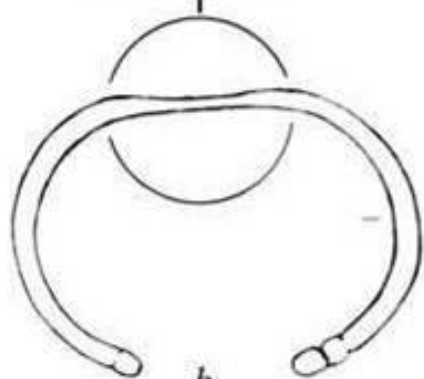
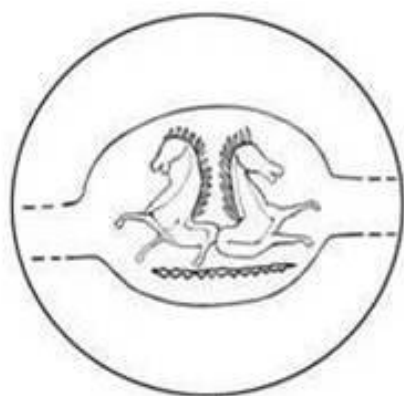
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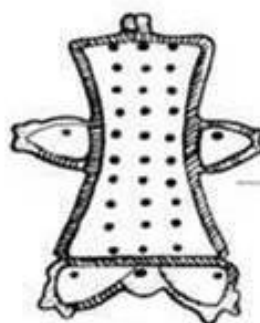
a) Calf-rings from Mzetamze.
 b) daggers from Mzetamze
 c) Daggers from Colchian collective graves



a.



b.

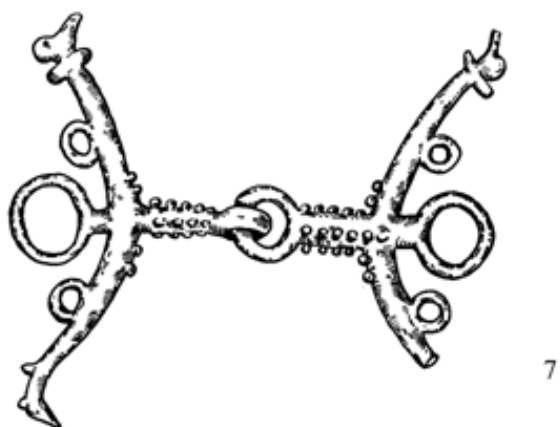
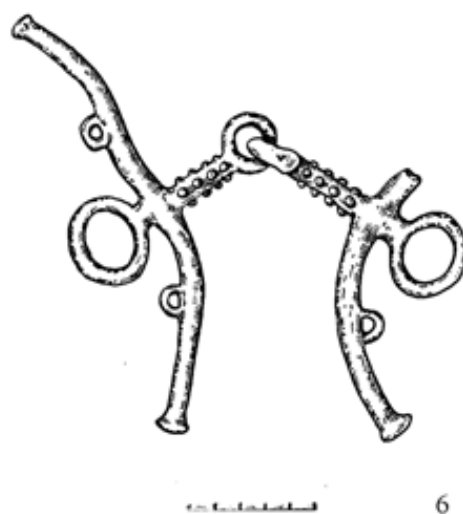
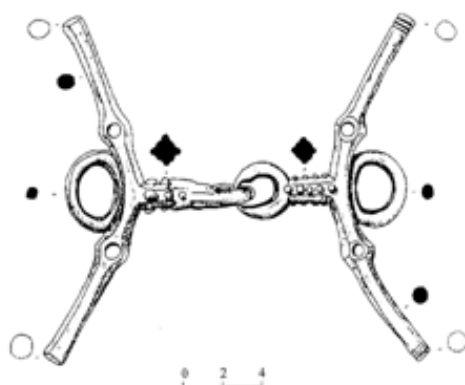
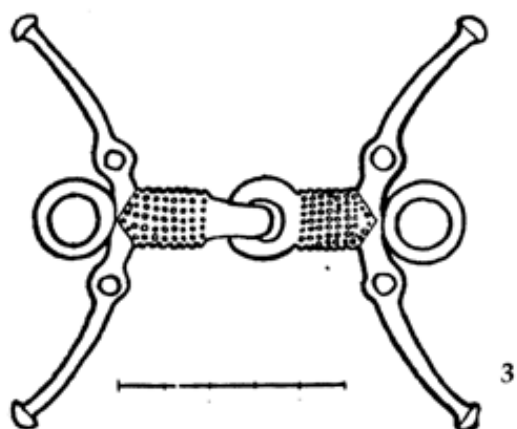
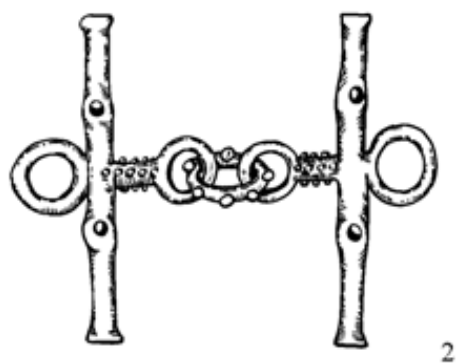
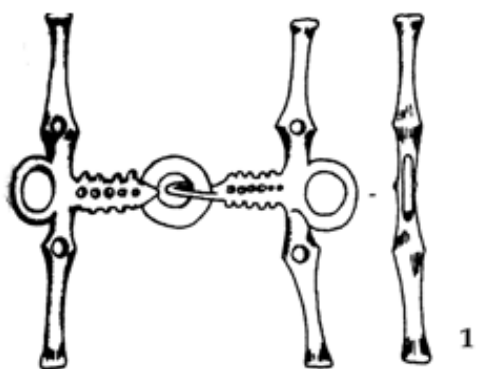


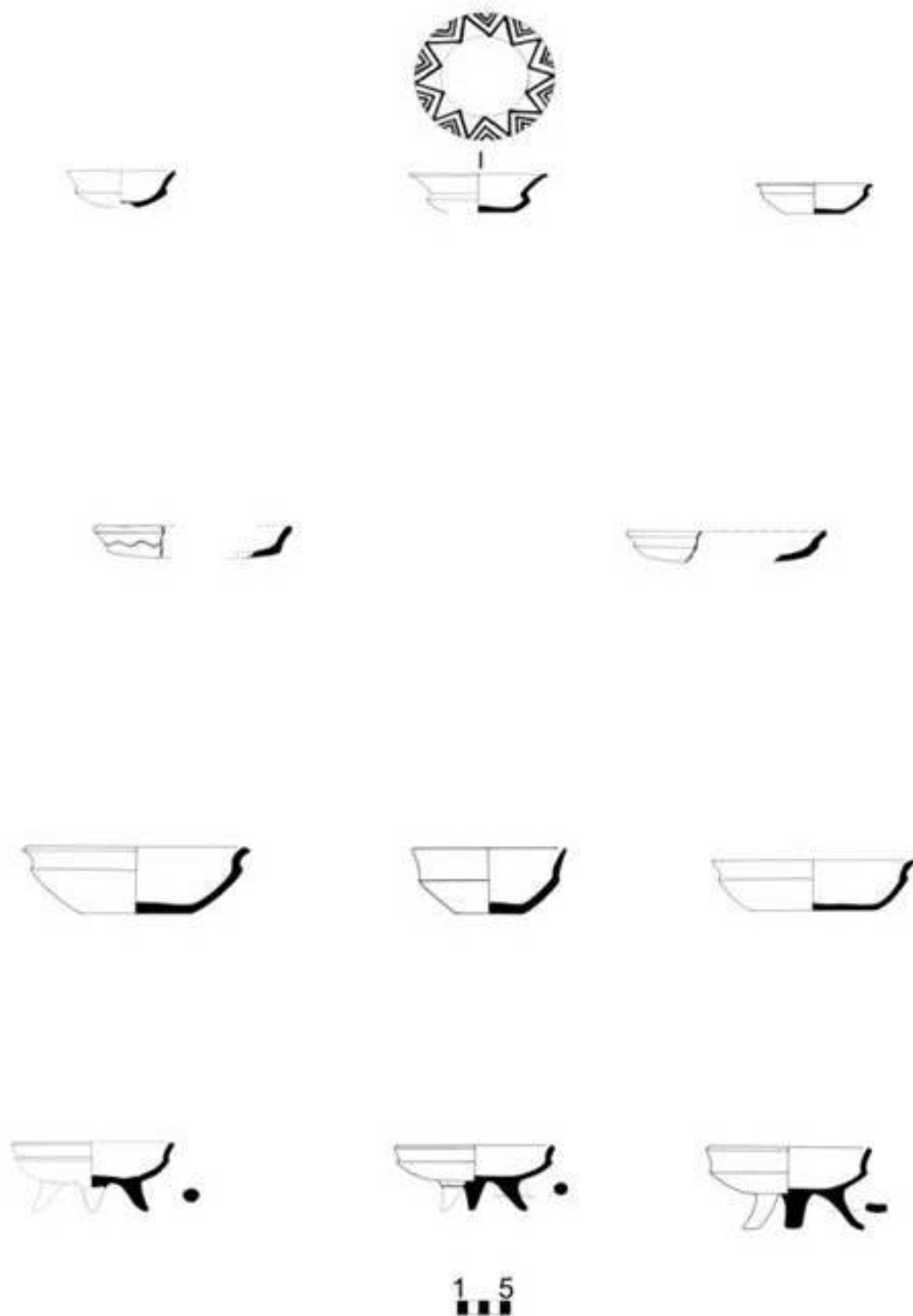
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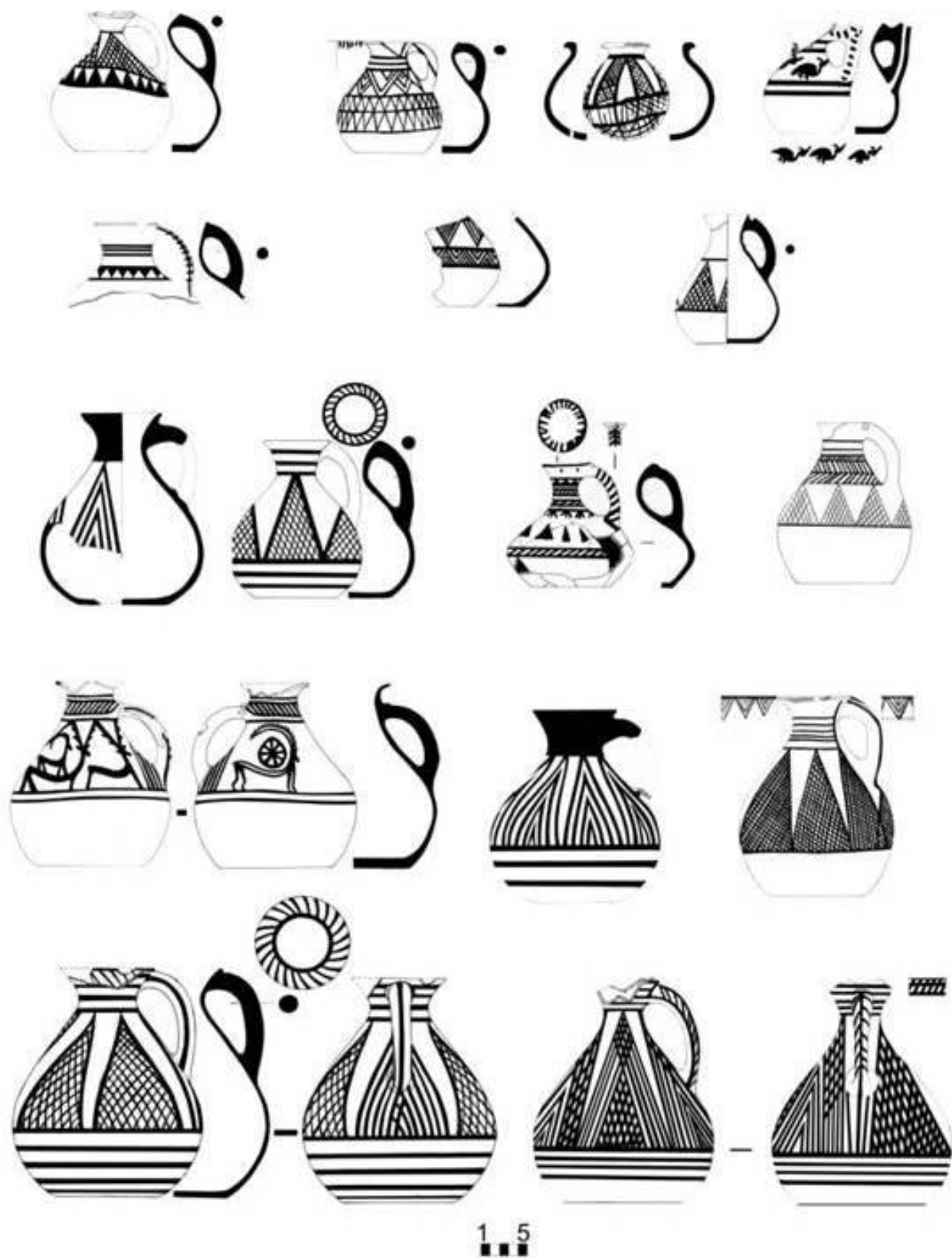
d.







"Achaemenid type" cups from Grakliani Gora



'Achaemenid type' painted pottery from Grakliani Gora